



National digital infrastructure for Uzbekistan's tourism sector

A single platform connecting the international traveller, the rural service provider, the tour operator and the state within one digital perimeter.

APPLICATION FOR STATE FUNDING

Tashkent · 2026

One platform — four portals — the entire sector

SAFRON moves Uzbekistan's tourism sector out of phone calls and cash payments and into a single digital ecosystem: transparent statistics for the state, guaranteed quality for the traveller, and legal income for rural communities.

4

INTERCONNECTED
PORTALS

24

FEATURES IN THE FULL
PRODUCT SCOPE

3

INTERFACE LANGUAGES
AT MVP, 6 AT LAUNCH

100%

OF TRANSACTIONS IN
THE FORMAL ECONOMY

The state receives not a report, but a live stream of data on where travellers are, what they spend and which services are actually delivered on the ground.

The sector is growing faster than its infrastructure

11.7M

INTERNATIONAL TRAVELLERS
VISITED UZBEKISTAN IN 2025

+46.8% year on year

\$4.4B

TOURISM SERVICES
EXPORTED DURING 2025

Top 7 worldwide by growth

20M

TARGET ARRIVALS
BY 2030

State objective

\$6B

TARGET SERVICE EXPORTS
BY 2030

A 1.4-fold increase

The gap that has to be closed

Arrivals grew by almost half in a single year, yet rural bookings still run on phone calls and cash. Digitalisation lags behind demand — and that is precisely what constrains both service quality and the sector's tax base.

Sources: UN Tourism / Uzbektourism, 2025–2026

Five gaps holding the sector back

01

The rural digital divide

Yurt owners, artisans and guides have no booking systems. Only phone calls and cash — entirely outside the formal economy.

02

Agency overload

Up to 60% of a DMC manager's working time goes to calling providers, filling E-Mehmon forms by hand and building itineraries in Excel.

03

Concentrated arrivals

Travellers cluster around five monuments. Regions with authentic culture stay unreachable and unmonetised.

04

The budget penalty

Safe, high-quality travel is available only through expensive agencies. Budget travellers are left without navigation or language.

05

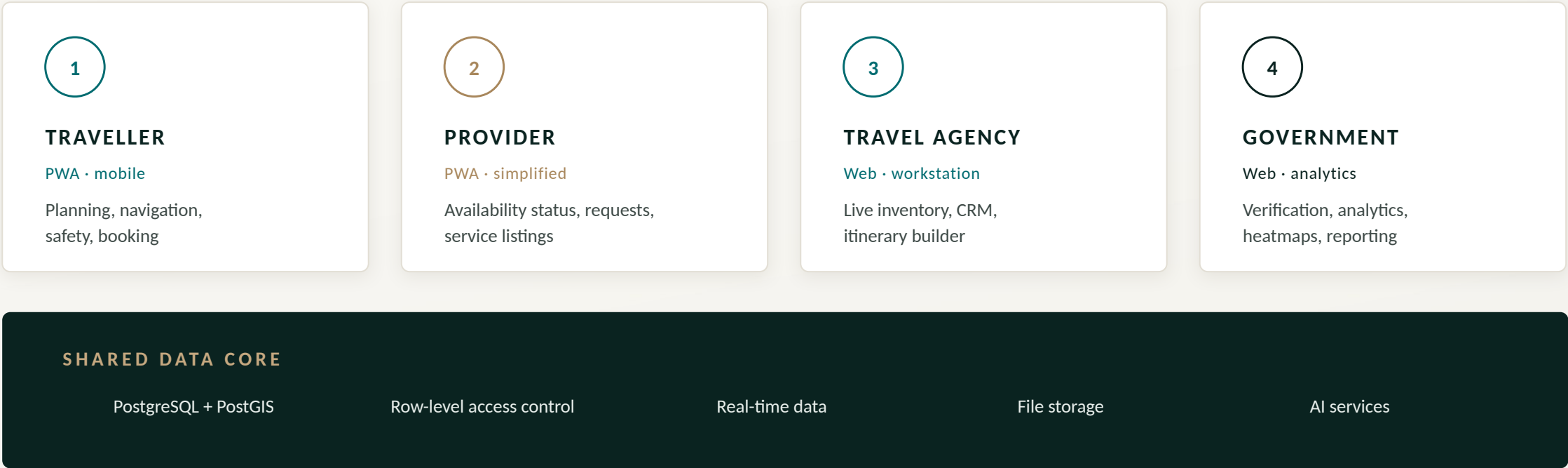
Low return rate

An identical route for everyone creates a sense that the country has been “completed”. With no showcase of live local events, there is no reason to return.

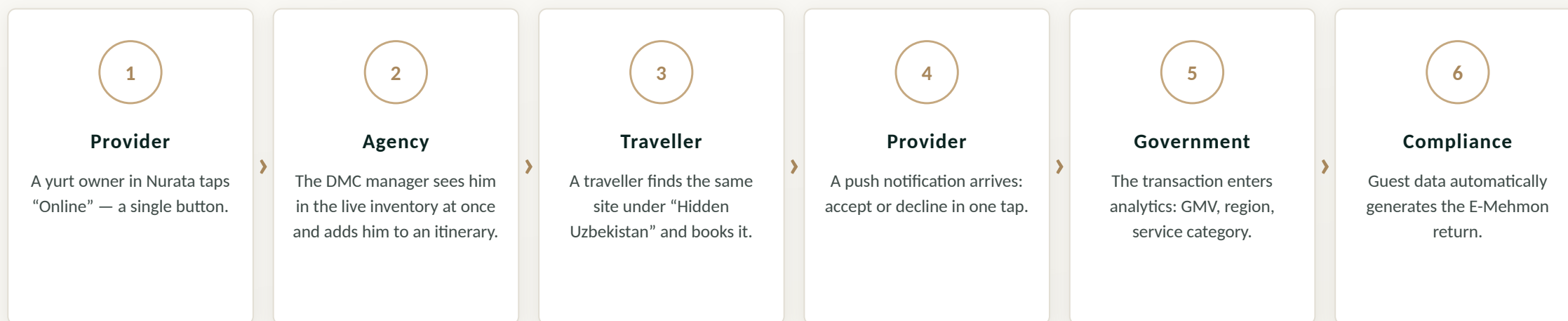
THE SOLUTION

Four portals on a single data core

Every role in the sector gets its own interface, but all of them work against one database. An action taken in one portal is instantly visible in all the others.



One booking travels through the whole ecosystem



Not one phone call. Not one cash payment outside the books. Not one form filled in by hand.

Four levels of maturity — 24 features

The slides that follow detail every feature. Below is the overall map.

LEVEL 1 Foundation and trust	5 features	Maps, translator, authentication for every role, PWA install by QR code
LEVEL 2 Engagement	9 features	Live provider status, bookings, CRM, menu scanner, notifications
LEVEL 3 Ecosystem connectivity	7 features	Verification, analytics, heatmaps, AI itinerary builder
LEVEL 4 Government perimeter	3 features	E-Mehmon automation, arrival redistribution, B2B resource pooling

Traveller: safety, language, discovery



T1

Survival Map

SOS points, clean restrooms, pharmacies, ATMs, Wi-Fi, cultural sites and festivals. Works offline.

T3

Hidden Uzbekistan

A showcase of authentic experiences direct from verified rural providers: masterclasses, yurt stays, active travel.

T5

Unified profile

Registration in under a minute, Google sign-in, saved itineraries and bookings.

T7

Live activity map

A heatmap showing where things are happening — and where it has simply become too crowded.

T2

Taste & Trust menu scanner

Photograph a menu in Uzbek or Russian → AI translates each dish, explains the ingredients and flags allergens.

T4

Contextual translator

Text and voice tuned to real situations: bargaining at the bazaar, taxis, explaining dietary needs. Core phrases offline.

T6

Contextual notifications

Alerts about what is happening nearby: a concert, a fair, a site closure, a weather warning.

T8

Impact Passport

Digital stamps for visiting lesser-known places — a mechanic that motivates travel into the regions.

Provider: rural business enters the digital economy

The interface is designed for a user with basic digital skills, an inexpensive Android and unreliable 3G. The main screen is a single button.

- P1 Availability toggle**
One tap for “Online” or “Offline”. The status propagates across every portal in under a second.
- P2 Booking management**
Push notification on a request, accept or decline in one click, a list of confirmed orders.
- P3 Service listing**
Photo upload, price, duration, capacity. AI translates the description into English and Russian automatically.
- P4 Simplified registration**
Name, phone and service type only. Confirmation by SMS code, with no complex forms.
- P5 AI service standardisation**
The system brings listings to a consistent quality: it flags missing details and suggests a market-appropriate price.

What this changes

From shadow to record

Cash settlement is replaced by a transaction visible to the platform and to the state alike.

Demand without a middleman

The provider receives orders directly from travellers and agencies, not only through personal contacts.

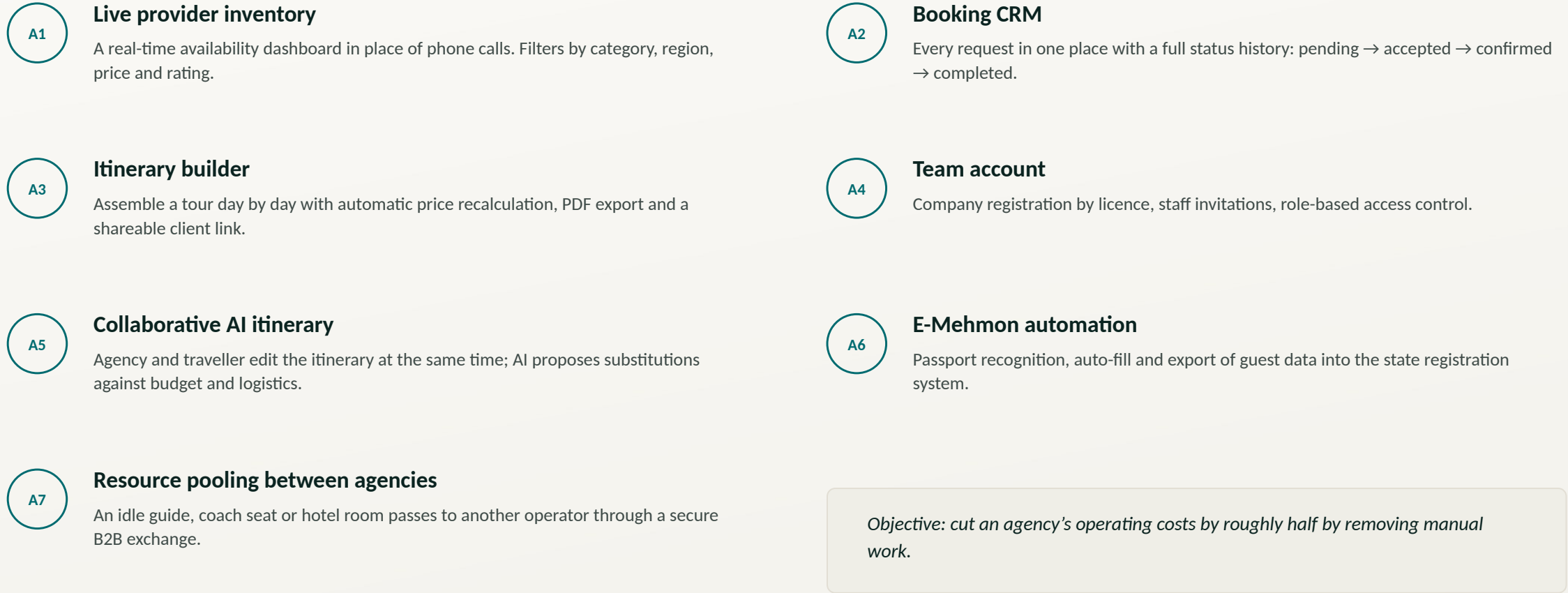
Income stays in the region

Money remains where the service was delivered instead of settling in capital-city intermediation.

A minimal barrier to entry

Registration takes under two minutes and requires neither an accountant nor a computer.

Travel agency: the operator's workstation



Government: the sector becomes observable

M1

Verification hub

Document review and admission of rural providers and agencies onto the platform. Quality control and traveller safety.

M2

Platform analytics

Active travellers, verified providers, bookings, GMV, trends by region and by service category.

M3

Arrival heatmap

Anonymised geodata from active sessions reveals genuine traveller density and infrastructure bottlenecks.

Data that nobody has today

- Where travellers are at any given moment
- Which routes are overloaded and which stand idle
- What the rural service sector actually earns
- What share of payments has left cash circulation



Artificial intelligence as infrastructure

AI in SAFRON addresses four practical tasks. None of them is decorative — each removes a specific barrier standing between the traveller, the provider and the state.

1

The language barrier

Translation of menus, signage and conversation with cultural context rather than word for word.

The traveller stops depending on a guide for everyday situations.

2

Food safety

Recognition of ingredients and allergens from a photograph of the menu.

The risk to travellers with dietary restrictions is removed.

3

Quality of supply

Automatic translation and standardisation of service descriptions.

A rural provider looks no worse on the showcase than a capital-city hotel.

4

Itinerary planning

Composing and recomposing a tour against budget, logistics and site congestion.

An agency builds an itinerary in minutes instead of hours.

E-Mehmon: from a manual form to an automatic flow

TODAY

- A manager retypes every guest's passport details by hand
- Input errors distort the national statistics
- Reporting arrives late and cannot be reconciled
- Rural services never enter the record at all

WITH THE SAFRON PLATFORM

- + The passport is read by camera and the fields populate themselves
- + Data arrives machine-readable, with no manual entry
- + The return is generated at the moment of booking, not after the fact
- + Every rural service becomes a recorded transaction

Alignment with the Digital Uzbekistan 2030 strategy

Digital public services

A sector service in place of paper document flow

Smart tourism

Direct execution of the Smart Tourism roadmap

The data economy

A national dataset on traveller movement

Managing arrivals as an instrument of state policy

1

Dynamic arrival redistribution API

The platform calculates traveller density around key sites in real time. When Registan or Ichan-Kala becomes congested, the system automatically raises the visibility and appeal of alternative routes within the same region — and offers them to the traveller before they end up in the queue.

- Less pressure on cultural heritage sites
- Higher utilisation of under-visited regions
- Flow management without bans or quotas

2

Resource pooling between agencies

An idle guide, a coach seat or an unoccupied room held by one operator becomes available to another through a secure B2B exchange inside the platform. Idle capacity across the sector converts into revenue.

- Less downtime for vehicles and guides
- Capacity to absorb the peak season
- Cooperation in place of a fragmented market

An architecture built for national scale

Interfaces

Next.js · React · TypeScript

Four independently deployable applications in a single repository sharing one component library.

Data

PostgreSQL 15 · PostGIS

Geospatial queries for maps and heatmaps execute inside the database itself, with no external service.

Access

Row-Level Security · JWT

Access rules live at the database row level rather than in application code — they cannot be bypassed.

Real time

Realtime subscriptions

A change in provider status reaches the agency and the traveller in under a second.

Mobility

PWA · Service Worker

Installation by QR code with no app store. Maps and core phrases remain available offline.

Integrations

Mapbox · AI · Payme / Click

Local payment systems as the primary settlement channel, international ones as a supplement.

Targets: API response under 200 ms · map load under 2 seconds · 10,000 concurrent users at launch, 100,000 in year two.

Security and accessibility are built in from the start

Data protection

Encryption

TLS 1.3 in transit, AES-256 at rest

Access control

Rules enforced at the database row level

Personal data

GDPR-aligned processing from day one

Anonymisation

Heatmaps are built without identifying individuals

Accessibility

WCAG AA standard

Contrast of at least 4.5:1, full keyboard navigation

Screen readers

Complete ARIA labelling across all four portals

Weak connectivity

Fully operable on unreliable rural 3G

Minimum screen

Correct layout from 320 pixels wide

Languages

First stage

Uzbek, Russian, English — interface and content

Second stage

French, Chinese, Arabic

Auto-translation

Service listings translated by AI on publication

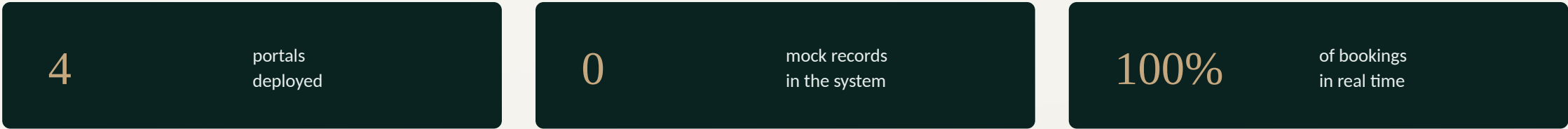
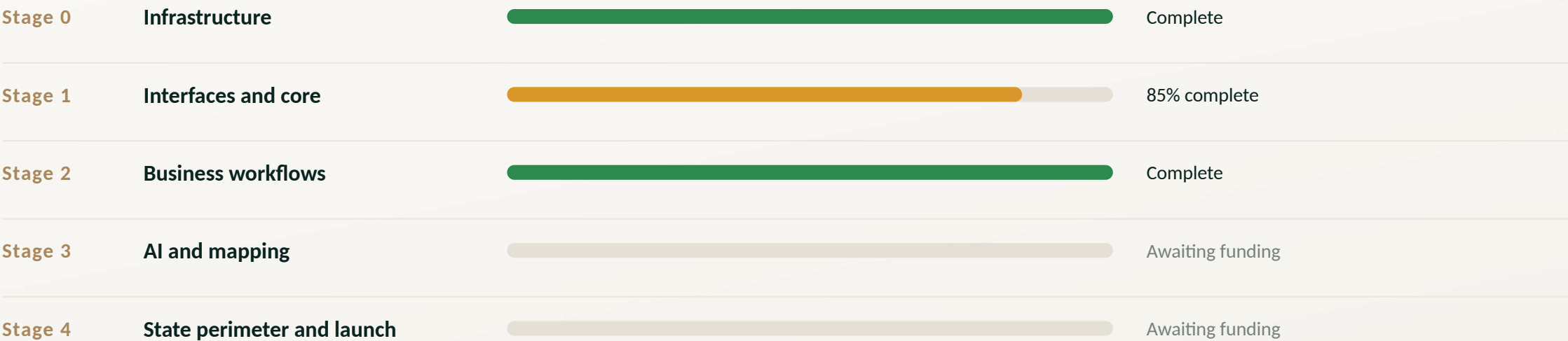
Scripts

Correct rendering of both Cyrillic and Latin

CURRENT STATUS

This is not a concept — the platform already runs

The project has completed three development stages funded by the team itself. A working system backed by a real database is available for demonstration today.



What funding unlocks over the next 12 months

MONTHS 1-3

Completing stage 3

- AI-powered menu scanner
- Contextual translator
- Survival Map on Mapbox and PostGIS
- Itinerary builder with auto-pricing

MONTHS 4-6

The state perimeter

- Passport recognition and E-Mehmon export
- Payme and Click integration
- Payouts to rural providers
- Security audit

MONTHS 7-9

Regional pilot

- 50 verified providers
- 5 partner agencies
- Pilot region: Navoi and Nurata
- On-site provider training

MONTHS 10-12

National launch

- QR points at airports and hotels
- Arrival redistribution
- Resource pooling between agencies
- Three further interface languages

Revenue model and target indicators

Revenue streams

Booking commission

10–15% of the service value

PRIMARY STREAM

Agency subscription

Access to live inventory and CRM

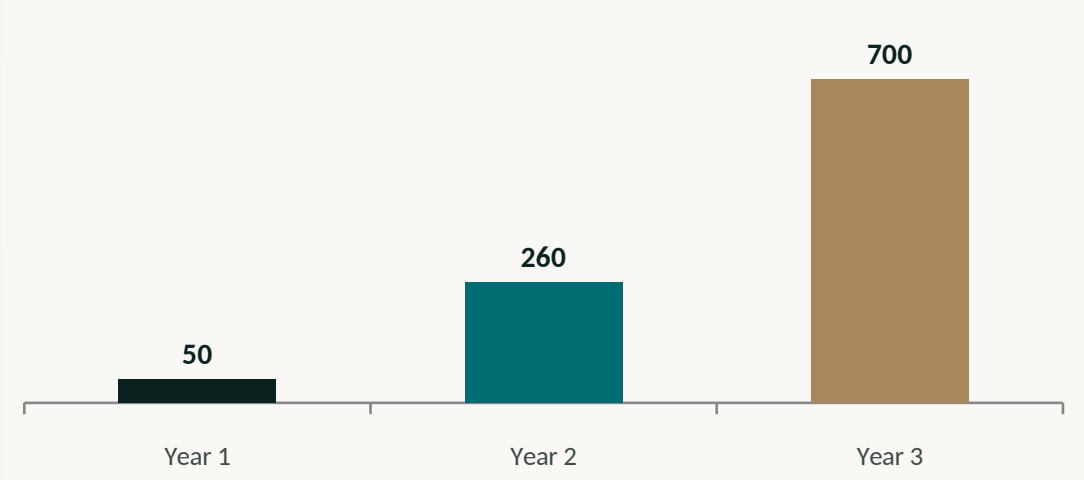
RECURRING B2B REVENUE

Showcase promotion

Priority placement for verified providers

SUPPLEMENTARY REVENUE

Target platform turnover (GMV), \$ thousand



500

travellers
in 90 days

50

verified
providers

200

bookings
in 90 days

> 50

Net Promoter
Score

15%

repeat
bookings

What the country gains, not just the platform



Formalising rural income

Cash settlement gives way to recorded transactions. The tax base widens without raising any rate.

Levelling arrivals

Demand shifts from five overloaded sites towards dozens of under-visited regions.

Protecting heritage

Lower pressure on UNESCO sites through flow management rather than restriction.

Regional employment

The artisan, the guide and the yurt owner gain a direct sales channel with no middleman.

Quality and safety

Provider verification and ratings establish a predictable standard of service.

National data

For the first time, a reliable real-time picture of traveller movement across the country.

Year one: at least \$20,000 of income reaching rural providers directly, and 200 transactions moved out of cash circulation.

Risks named in advance and closed with measures

RISK	LEVEL	MITIGATION
Weak rural connectivity	High	Aggressive offline caching and a minimal data footprint in the provider application.
Access to state systems	High	A retrying request queue, independent document recognition and a manual fallback path.
Low digital literacy among providers	Medium	A single-button interface, SMS registration and on-site training in the pilot region.
Cost of external AI services	Medium	Caching of frequent requests, per-user limits and budget alerts.
Dependence on foreign payment rails	High	Payme and Click as the primary settlement channel; international systems as a supplement.
PWA limitations on iOS	Medium	Safari testing and an alternative interface for unsupported features.

THE ASK

What we are asking for

Twelve months of funding — to complete stages 3 and 4, run the regional pilot and reach national launch.

45%

Engineering team

A team of 5–6 specialists over 12 months

15%

State integrations

E-Mehmon, Payme and Click, security audit

20%

Regional pilot and training

Provider onboarding, field work, training

10%

Infrastructure and external services

Hosting, mapping, AI services, monitoring

10%

Launch and distribution

QR points, materials, agency outreach

Beyond funding

Access to E-Mehmon

A programmatic interface for automatic transfer of guest data

Partner status

Formal recognition of the platform as a sector solution

Pilot region

Agreement on Navoi and Nurata as the first-stage territory

Distribution points

Placement of QR codes at airports and border crossings

The exact amount requested and an itemised budget are provided in the annex to this application.

The country already has the arrivals.
What remains is the infrastructure to manage them.



We are ready to demonstrate the platform live at a time that suits you.

Tashkent • 2026